

I intend to do some sort of corpus study in the Luhya language family. A corpus study in linguistics involves a large body of text (spoken or written), called a corpus or corpora. This data can reveal different patterns about a language than other forms of data collection, because the data is not initially collected by a linguist for linguistic-study purposes, naturally revealing patterns that may occur only between speakers or in casual settings. The corpus I will be working with is a collection of stories, or oral literature, told by native Tiriki speakers.

As an alternate project concept, in case something goes wrong with the first, I am considering designing a dashboard that would help a user visualize ‘linguistic distance’, or how different languages are from each other. I am interested in this because I think it is important to know how some languages are recognized as distinct languages despite being mutually intelligible – meaning, speakers of one can understand the other – and some are considered dialects of the same language despite not being mutually intelligible. It would be interesting to create a dashboard to visualize how many shared/different linguistic features exist across dialects.

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